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The Influence and Change of China's Double Reduction Policy on International Education

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Overview and Program Statement

On July 24, 2021, the General Office of the Central Committee of the Communist Party of China and the General Office of the State Council issued the "Opinions on Further Reducing the Burden of Homework and Off-campus Training for Students in Compulsory Education" (Xie, 2021). It clearly states that, on the one hand, it is necessary to reduce the homework burden of students in the compulsory education stage (students in grades 1-9); on the other hand, resolutely reduce the off-campus training of subjects. Off-campus training institutions cannot take up national statutory holidays, rest days, and winter and summer vacations to organize subject-based training.

The growth and enrollment of training schools have increased students' extracurricular learning burden and many parents' time cost and financial burden. At the same time, due to the inequality of educational resources between urban and rural students, the gap in education quality is even more significant. However, in the process of implementing the "double reduction" policy, some parents still felt confused and anxious, so they chose to continue to let their children participate in after-school tutoring, "live-in teachers," and other forms of after-school tutoring began to appear. In order to avoid such a situation from continuing, many schools have adopted the method of after-school tutoring for students, supporting the implementation of the double reduction policy and trying to make education

fair without increasing the burden on students and parents.

Program objectives and goals

Talking about private international schools. After carefully reading the "Double reduction" policy rules, we believe this creates a good time for private schools to adjust their day-to-day operations. For instance, the policy document aims to reduce the burden on students by limiting the amount of homework. At the same time, it requires schools to provide students with more non-academic education courses, combining academic education with extracurricular activities to promote students' overall development.

Under these two goals, private schools should further improve the homework management methods, reasonably regulate the homework structure, and ensure that the difficulty of homework does not exceed the national curriculum standards. In addition, private schools should make full use of their resource advantages, effectively carry out various extracurricular education activities, meet the diverse learning needs of students in schools, and guide students to participate in extracurricular services voluntarily.

As an International School, requiring students to use a certain level of English is the most significant task to understand the other subjects. However, students can only learn English at school without learning in the training school under the policy. Therefore, helping students who lack English abilities in ESL/ELA classes is the priority. This paper will introduce how the international school I work for supports the double reduction policy and what measures are implemented to implement these rules to achieve the goal. I will evaluate

in several aspects: Does the "double reduction" policy effectively solve parents' burden? Do students who stop tutoring from the training institutions have better grades with the help of the school teachers? What did the teachers do? How do teachers work with parents to supervise students' learning?

Logic Model

The logical model is a detailed outline of project activities and expected outcomes. In the past decades, as long as parents and teachers feel that students should work through the night, the homework experience will remain the same. Students may be forced to do their homework at home or school rather than in a private tutoring center, but they still do it (Mikesell, 2021).

INPUTS	OUTPUTS		OUTCOMES		
	Activities	Participants	Short-term	Medium-term	Long-term
- Qualified teachers - After-class tutoring plan - Individualized development training plan - Sufficientfunding - Online education resources - Families	- The academic department reset the teaching plan based on the policy requirement. - Academic Affairs re-set the daily school schedule (daily classes, after-class tutoring, one on one office time coaching, PA clubs). - Call for meetings with subject teachers and Homeroom teachers. - Train more qualified teachersCommunicate with parents often to cooperate so that monitoring students' study process better. - School Office & Finance Department make a budget to cover the fees for teachers.	- All teachers & school leaders in the school. - School administrators - School coordinator & local education bureau - Parents - Students	- Teachers fees being covered - Parents learn strategies to monitor the progress of their child(ren).	Students achieve some other skills or change behaviors, gain more knowledge from the school, gain more experience in different fields, and broaden the horizon.	- Sustainability of the budget for paying teacher fees. - All existing private academic tutoring and academic training institutions are converted to "not-for-profit" organizations or teach other non-academic subjects for profit. - The teaching quality of teachers in the school is improved. - In addition to academic advancement, students have other skills. - Education in China no longer only uses students' academic performance as the only evaluation criterion but also comprehensively examines students' abilities. - The policy promotes equality in the education sector.

To support the double reduction policy, our school are focusing on train more qualified teachers, especially young teachers who lack of teaching experiences, because they will be the major group of education participant. And another one of the most important

element is the funding. So far, our school is the main funder to support this program.

Next, we have teachers, parents and students in the program. They purpose is to reduce the students' and parents burden, that makes our teachers' workload gets more. Teachers put more efforts on the program, they learned and practiced more than before. Meanwhile, the school will pay more to cover their extra work. Moreover, even though the parents don't feel as much pressures as before, they still are willing to cooperate with the school to let their children do better under the circumstances. Therefore, parents and teachers communicate and give feedback to each others and monitor the students' behavior, to make the improvement more effective.

In the short-term, as I mentioned up above, teachers fees being covered, and parents learned strategies to take care of the children. When the program goes further, with the healthy study environment, students will achieve some other skills or gain more knowledge or experience in different fields, and broaden the horizon. I believe this program is good for the sustainability of education, and there will be more parents are satisfied with it, and feel like to donate or pay more on the program. In the future, education in China is no longer only uses student's academic performance as the only evaluation criterion but also comprehensively examines student's abilities.

Implementation Plan

The double-reduction policy requires schools to guarantee after-school service hours for students. Schools should make full use of resource advantages, effectively implement

various after-school education activities, and meet the diverse study needs of students in the school. Guide students to volunteer for after-school service. Improve the quality of after-school services. Schools should formulate implementation plans for after-school services to enhance the attractiveness of after-school services. Make full use of after-school service time to guide students to complete their homework conscientiously. Also, expand learning space for students with spare capacity, and carry out a variety of popular science, style, art, labor, reading, Interest groups, and community activities.

This program is mainly managing by our school, it includes administration leaders and academic directors. All 7th - 9th grade students and their parents are the main beneficiaries, because the goal of double reduction policy is to reduce the two participants' pressures. And also, the school leaders and teachers are involved of the program. School will train more qualified teachers to improve their teaching skills and caring students better, in a way, teachers are also the beneficiaries. Since the policy also mentioned release parents' burden, all after-class coaching are totally free on the campus, so the school provides funding, and teachers communicate with parents to monitor the students' behaviors, they are volunteers for the program. This program will length one semester, and it compares three different periods which are grade 7 to grade 9 students' English proficiency before the they enrolled the school, mid-term English scores and final-term English scores.

Outcomes and Measures

1) Double reduction policy focuses mainly on using the homework and the

homework workload for the students and parents. In order to accomplish that, our school has reduced the total number of homework given to the students daily. So that way, we are ensuring that students will finish the homework within 45 to 90 minutes, depending on the grade they are studying in. Apart from that, we will also allow the students to be here. During the night study after school, the night study happens from 5:30 pm up to about 7 pm. Furthermore, during that time of about one and a half hours, students are guided and trained by their subject and homework teachers who help them with their homework. That way, when the students get back home, they are already done with their homework. So the parents do not have to worry about getting them to finish the homework.

2) The double reduction policy also pays much attention to giving students more opportunities to do extracurricular activities, be part of more clubs, etc. In order to accomplish that, our school has opened free extracurricular clubs for all of our students after school. They happened from 4:30 pm to 5:35 pm. Students can choose from a range of different after-school clubs that allow our students to have some time to themselves and be able to use those activities to improve their physical abilities and skills.

3) The third most important thing that we are focusing on regarding the double reduction policy is what standard training centers will provide. So we are allowing all of our students that are having any difficulty in any of their subjects or any of their courses or topics in those courses for that matter. Generally speaking, what we do is any of the students that are struggling, we will arrange for them to have one-on-one makeup classes after school or even during school time with their subject or other teachers. We are also not charging the parents

or the students any money for that. So that does not put any more burden on the parents. Moreover, students are still able to do the work done.

4) We are also allowing the students to stay here over the weekend if they wish to. So this way, if they cannot go back home because of any arrangements or if their parents have a busy lifestyle, their kids can stay here in the dorms. And our dorm teachers train them and help them with multiple things related to academics. Therefore, our school provides a complete package for all students studying here.

Data Collection Plan and Data Analysis Plan

I used a mixed method to evaluate the impact of China's "double reduction policy" on the English proficiency of grade 7-9 students in the school where I work. First of all, I used the quantitative method to collect and compare the English test level of these students at the time of enrolled with their scores in the middle and final exams. Samples are follows:

Samples of some students' personal information

Grade	Name	Subject	Tutoring Fee/year (RMB)	After School Tutoring time/week(hours)
7	Jason	English	¥ 60,000	12
8	Tommy	English	¥ 45,000	10
9	Clove	English	¥ 55,000	12

Samples of some students' English Level

Name	Enrolled	Middle-term	Final-term
Jason	A	A	A*

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Tommy	B+	A-	A
Clove	A-	A	A

Then I made a questionnaire for students, parents, and English teachers to fill in, including students' daily learning time, homework time, parents' satisfaction, English teachers' satisfaction with students' class (class participation, homework completion, attendance rate).

Sample of questionnaire

Name:_____ Grade:_____ ☐ Student ☐ Parent ☐ Teacher

1. Students' after school daily learning time ( )

a) 30mins b) 60mins c) 90mins d) over 2hrs

2. Homework time ( )

a) 30mins b) 60mins c) 90mins d) over 2hrs

3. Parents' satisfaction ( )

a) Very satisfied b) Neutral c) Unsatisfied d) Extremely Unsatisfied

Note: Feel free to contact with academic department and give us precious advice

4. English teachers' satisfaction with students' class (grade a score)

Participation, and discussion	Homework/assignments, presentations, labs, essays, artwork	Quizzes and tests	Mid-term exam	Final-exam
20%	35%	25%	10%	10%

Then based on the questionnaire sample, I conducted qualitative research and interviewed students with high, medium, and low scores to understand their situation. Finally,

combining these two methods, the analysis result is obtained -- the influence of the double reduction policy on the English level of students in grades 7-9 of our school.

80% of the 40 parents are satisfied with the program, so they can have more family time together, and send children to learn more skills, such as arts and sports. And it saved a sum of money only to invest students' English learning in the training school. 95% of the students' feedback are satisfied because they don't have to do so many homework. 88% of the teachers feel that even though the workload gets more, they gained more experience and that extra work has being covered by the school. Furthermore, it makes teaching productive because 92% of the students' score get improved, or at least stable. That makes students be confident and passionate on study.

Policy Objectives

As the directly responsible person for the implementation of "double reduction," teachers must not simply equate "double reduction" with "reduce exams and homework" but should actively seek teaching improvement.

The policy is anticipated to bring equality across different classes in the Chinese society, primarily focusing on the upper class, upper middle class and middle class by giving students of all classes access to the same education system, same after-school clubs and homework support. At the same time, the policy is expected to lighten the burden on parents financially and physically.

The policy is expected to bring some positive results in the form of reducing the burden on middle and upper-middle-class parents financially and physically with parents not needing to help too much with homework for their kids. With most training center businesses shutting down, most parents will be forced to rely more on after school arrangements from public school bringing some level of standard.

However, the policy is expected to add more burden to the teachers, especially in public schools, and the fact that educators aren't being given a pay raise doesn't help matters. This might lead to more and more people not desiring to choose education as a profession in the future bringing a huge shortage of teachers. Upper-class parents are still going to be hiring one on one teachers individually, which will lead to price surge in the after-school education industry. Although the government has promised to decrease the burden on parents by facilitating students life at schools, there is a still a part of their life after school and during the weekends for which several parents have chosen activities, PA classes and sport classes etc. which might be leading to a price surge in that industry still adding to the burden for parents.

All in all, the final outcome and impact of this policy are yet to be seen.

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